

Back End & APIs

Node.js, Express and REST · Equigrow short notes

A minimal Express server

```
import express from "express";
const app = express();
app.use(express.json());

let todos = [];
app.get("/todos", (req, res) => res.json(todos));
app.post("/todos", (req, res) => {
  const todo = { id: Date.now(), text: req.body.text };
  todos.push(todo);
  res.status(201).json(todo);
});
app.listen(3000, () => console.log("Running on 3000"));
```

REST basics

Method	Meaning	Example
GET	read	GET /todos
POST	create	POST /todos
PUT / PATCH	update	PATCH /todos/7
DELETE	remove	DELETE /todos/7

Status	Meaning
200 / 201	OK / Created
400	bad request (your input)
401 / 403	not logged in / not allowed
404	not found
500	server error

Must-knows

- Keep secrets (API keys, DB passwords) in environment variables, never in code.
- Validate every input on the server; never trust the client.
- Authentication: sessions or tokens (JWT). Hash passwords (bcrypt), never store them as plain text.
- Test APIs with Postman, Thunder Client or curl.